

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1173

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor Ellen Irlene Mandrell as an entertainer and a public servant.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing a multi-talented artist whose love for Tennessee is evident in all her endeavors; and

WHEREAS, at the tender age of eleven, Irlene Mandrell began playing drums in the family band that included her sisters and her father, a former traveling preacher and musician; and

WHEREAS, from these humble beginnings, Irlene Mandrell achieved national stardom on the long-running *Barbara Mandrell and the Mandrell Sisters Variety Show* that attracted more than forty million worldwide viewers per week; and

WHEREAS, sharing the spotlight with her sisters, Barbara and Louise, on the program, Irlene Mandrell wowed audiences with her singing talent and her comedic wit; and

WHEREAS, she later earned renown for her comedic performances on *Hee Haw* during the show's final eight years of production; and

WHEREAS, Irlene Mandrell has appeared on numerous other television programs, including *The Tonight Show*, *The Oprah Winfrey Show*, and *The Love Boat*; and

WHEREAS, Irlene Mandrell co-hosted *Bright Lights and Country Nights* and *This Week in Country Music* on television; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to accolades, she has won two Comedy Act of the Year awards and a North American Country Music Association International Award and has been honored with her own star on the Country Music Walkway of the Stars; and

WHEREAS, music runs deeply in Irlene Mandrell's blood, a trait that is demonstrated in her single "We Will Stand," which reached No. 1 on the Independent Country Charts in 2017;

this success was followed by "You Ain't Nothin' But a Heartache," which reached the top ten and charted for sixteen weeks in 2018; and

WHEREAS, a lady of abiding faith, Irene Mandrell authored *God Rains Miracles*, which reached No. 8 on Amazon's Religion & Spirituality bestseller list in 2018; she now hosts the *God Rains Miracles* radio show and podcast; and

WHEREAS, Irlene Mandrell can trace her roots back to 1819 Sumner County, and after touring and experiencing the world as an entertainer for many years, she has returned to these roots; and

WHEREAS, Irlene Mandrell gives back to her community through her work with Holiday Fest and Christmas 4 Kids in Sumner County; her involvement with the Nashville Humane Society; her performances at numerous benefits for local heroes, veterans, and first responders; and her generous support of numerous civic and charitable organizations and events that serve her community; and

WHEREAS, Irlene Mandrell possesses an innate authenticity and affability that inspires a connection with her fans, and these same qualities, in addition to her lifetime of hard work and dedication, make her a valuable citizen of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Ellen Irlene Mandrell as a gifted entertainer and a devoted public servant and thank her for her many contributions to Sumner County and the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

